

ALFRED

YOUR AI BUTLER

Operations Manual & Field Guide

DAVE DOUGLAS JR. EDITION

Built 2026-05-23

v1.0 — for when you ask: “wait, what can this thing do?”

Personal property of Dave Douglas Jr. / /Users/sankore/Documents/Work/Claude Batcave/dave-assistant/

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This manual exists so you don't have to remember everything Alfred can do. Flip to any section, copy the recipe phrases, and your bot grows with you.

00

Welcome

Who this is for

You're Dave Douglas Jr. — fifteen-year journeyman steamfitter, building a trades-influencer brand as @dadailydougie, paying down \$32k in IRS debt by Feb 2027, and trying to actually use your tools (including the digital ones) instead of letting them sit in the truck. This manual is for that Dave.

How to use it

Treat this like the install guide for a tankless water heater: skim once so you know what's in it, then come back to specific sections when you need them. Every section ends with concrete things you can do or say to Claude to make Alfred do more for you.

The recipe phrases

Throughout this manual you'll see lines marked **RECIPE:**. Those are word-for-word things you can say to Claude (in this Desktop window OR in the terminal Claude Code) to make Alfred do that thing. Copy, paste, send.

STATUS

Alfred is fully live as of 2026-05-23. He texts you twice (SMS and Telegram) on three different schedules and costs \$0/month to run. The rest of this manual is about getting more out of him.

01

What is Alfred?

The 30-second pitch

Alfred is a personal AI butler that runs in the cloud 24/7. He reads your email and calendar, scans the news, thinks through what you should know, and texts you. You don't open an app — he comes to your phone. Three jobs, three schedules, no monthly cost.

What he runs on (in 60 seconds, no jargon)

Supabase — a free cloud platform that hosts Alfred's brain and runs the timers that wake him up. Think of it like the electrical service that powers a job site.

Edge Functions — three small programs Alfred runs: one for the morning briefing, one to watch your inbox for fire alarms, one to remind you about appointments.

Google Gemini — the AI brain. Free tier, plenty of room for what Alfred does. He uses it to read your emails and decide which ones need your eyeballs today versus which can wait.

Two delivery channels — every message goes out as a regular SMS (via Gmail → T-Mobile gateway) AND as a Telegram message. If one channel breaks, the other still lands. You don't miss the alert.

Privacy and security

Alfred only reads YOUR Gmail and YOUR Google Calendar — he has read-only access to both (plus send-only for the SMS gateway). No one else can use this bot — it's configured for your phone and your accounts only. All secrets (passwords, tokens) live encrypted in Supabase, never in chat or in code.

If you ever want to kill Alfred's access entirely: go to **myaccount.google.com** → Security → Third-party apps with account access → remove Alfred. He goes dark immediately.

02

What Alfred does today

Job #1 — The morning briefing

WHEN	Every day at 6:00 AM Eastern (10:00 UTC)
WHAT	A detailed text covering: greeting, top 5 news headlines with context, your full calendar for today, email triage (urgent/money/opportunity/noise), today's single highest-leverage move, and a closer.
HOW LONG	1,800–2,400 characters — arrives as one Telegram message and 2-3 SMS chunks.
DATA SOURCES	Top news via BBC RSS, your Google Calendar (next 24h), your Gmail (last 24h).
WHY 6 AM	Catches you before you leave for the site. Updated from the original 7 AM — you wanted the lead time.

Job #2 — The urgent email scanner

WHEN	Every 30 minutes , all day, every day
WHAT	Reads new emails arriving at bklyncaviar@gmail.com. Gemini scores each one 1-10 on urgency (specific to you as a tradesman/business owner). Anything 8+ triggers a text alert with sender, subject, and a preview.

WHY 8+	High bar by design — anything lower would buzz your phone constantly. Promotional emails, newsletters, and notifications all score low. Real customer messages, IRS notices, urgent project updates score high.
DEDUP	Each email gets remembered after the first scan. You won't get re-texted about the same email twice.

Job #3 — Calendar reminders

WHEN	Every 15 minutes , all day
WHAT	Looks at your Google Calendar. Texts you 1 hour before any event, then again 15 minutes before. Includes location if you put one in.
WHY TWO PINGS	First one gives you time to wrap up what you're doing. Second one is the "leave NOW" nudge.
DEDUP	Each event's reminders fire exactly once — marked as sent in the database.

Where Alfred reaches you

Both channels fire in parallel for every notification. If one fails, the other still delivers.

SMS (text)	9175182963 via T-Mobile's free email-to-SMS gateway. Reliable, no monthly cost.
TELEGRAM	Your private chat with @your_alfred_bot. Longer messages stay intact (no SMS chunking). Better formatting.

03

How to read your morning briefing

Your 6 AM briefing has six sections. Same order, every day, so your eyes know where to land. Here’s what each section means and how to use it.

Section 1 — Good morning Dave

Warm acknowledgment of the day. Mon vs Fri vs weekend gets different energy. If anything seasonal or timely is going on (heat wave, holiday, payroll Friday), it shows up here.

Section 2 — News digest

Top 5 headlines pulled from BBC. Each headline gets one sentence of context — why it matters or what the implication is. NY-specific, economy, trades, and construction stories get more attention. Pure fluff gets a single line and Alfred moves on.

Use case: small talk on the job site. You walked in already knowing today’s headlines.

Section 3 — Today’s schedule

Every calendar event in chronological order: time, what, where, and any prep tip if obvious (“leave 15 min early” / “bring the change order”). If the day is light or empty, Alfred suggests 1-2 ways to fill it tied to your goals (post a reel, push the davedouglasjr.com hosting question).

Section 4 — Email triage

Last 24 hours of emails categorized into buckets. Only buckets with entries show up.

NEEDS RESPONSE	Real people waiting on you. Always read these first.
MONEY / INVOICE	Anything financial — invoices owed to you, IRS notices, payment confirmations. Critical given the Feb 2027 IRS payoff plan.

OPPORTUNITY	Brand deals, leads, gigs, jobs. The pipeline for @dadailydougie and the influencer brand lives here.
NOISE	Just a count — e.g. “12 promos/newsletters — ignore.” No actions needed.

Section 5 — Today’s move

The most important section. Alfred picks **one** high-leverage action for today and ties it to your goals (IRS payoff, influencer growth, website launch, or business). 2-3 sentences. If you only do one thing from the briefing, do this one.

Section 6 — Closer

One short line. Trades-flavored, no corporate cheese. Varies daily. The signal that the briefing is over.

ROBUSTNESS NOTE

If the briefing is missing a section or feels short, that means a data source didn’t respond (BBC News occasionally has hiccups). Alfred won’t skip the briefing — he’ll just note the gap and send what he has.

04

Customizing Alfred

Three layers of customization, ordered from “I’ll just ask” to “I know what I’m doing.”

Layer 1 — Just ask Claude

Easiest. Open this Desktop window or your terminal Claude, say what you want, Claude makes the change. You don’t need to know what to edit.

RECIPE: “Change the morning briefing time to 7 AM instead of 6 AM.”

RECIPE: “Make the urgent email threshold higher — only ping me on 9+ instead of 8+.”

RECIPE: “Add a section to the morning briefing called ‘IRS debt countdown’ that says how many days until Feb 1 2027 and the remaining balance.”

Layer 2 — Where the dials live

If you ever want to peek under the hood, here’s where to look:

Morning briefing prompt	supabase/functions/morning-briefing/index.ts
Email urgency threshold	supabase/functions/email-checker/index.ts (search for score >= 8)
Reminder timing	supabase/functions/calendar-reminder/index.ts
Number of news stories	morning-briefing/index.ts (search for getTopNews(5))
Cron schedules	Supabase dashboard → Database → Cron Jobs (or via SQL)

Layer 3 — Deploy after editing

Any code change needs a redeploy to take effect. The cron schedules pick up env-var changes immediately, but anything inside the function files needs:

```
supabase functions deploy morning-briefing
```

(or whichever function you changed). Claude can run this for you — just ask.

DST GOTCHA

Daylight savings reminder: the cron schedules are in UTC. When Eastern time switches between EDT (UTC-4) and EST (UTC-5), your 6 AM briefing will drift by an hour unless you update the cron. Mark Nov 1, 2026 on your calendar (or ask Alfred to remind you) — change 0 10 * * * to 0 11 * * *.

05

The menu: 40+ things you can have Alfred do

These are NOT yet built. They're ideas — a menu. Pick what fits your week, copy the RECIPE line, give it to Claude, and you'll have a new ability by end of session. Organized by life domain.

A. Financial — because you have a payoff date

Anything tied to your \$32k IRS payoff (Feb 2027) and general money sanity.

1. Bi-weekly debt countdown — every other Friday, Alfred texts your remaining balance, weeks left, and required pace. Keeps the goal in view.

***RECIPE:** "Add a bi-weekly Friday job at 4 PM that texts me the IRS payoff status: remaining balance, weeks until Feb 1 2027, required weekly payment to stay on track."*

2. Bill due-date watcher — scans emails for words like "invoice," "due," "payment." Texts you 3 days before any due date.

3. Spending alert — reads PayPal/Stripe receipts. If a single charge over \$X comes through, ping you.

4. Tax-withholding sanity check — monthly, calculate roughly whether your pay-stub withholdings + estimated payments are on pace for next April.

5. Bank balance via Plaid — morning briefing includes "Checking: \$X, Savings: \$Y". Plaid integration adds setup time but no monthly cost on free tier.

6. Monthly P&L pulse — last day of each month, summarize income / expenses / net from QuickBooks (or PayPal if no QB).

7. 'Should I do this gig?' calculator — you forward Alfred a job offer email, he replies with after-tax take-home and whether it fits your debt-paydown rate.

B. Content & influencer — because @dadailydougie won't grow itself

8. Daily content prompt — every morning at 7 AM (separate from the 6 AM briefing), Alfred sends one content idea tied to that day's job. "Film a 20-second 'what most homeowners don't know' about the boiler you're working on."

***RECIPE:** "Add a daily 7 AM job that texts me one trades-content idea based on the day of the week (Mon = monday motivation, Wed = how-to, Fri = funny fail)."*

9. Posting streak tracker — Alfred remembers when you last posted. If 48h pass with no post, he texts "hey, streak's breaking."

10. Engagement digest — Sunday night summary: which posts got the most likes/comments, what to double down on next week.

11. Comment priority queue — if you DM Alfred a screenshot of comments, he ranks which to reply to first (genuine question > potential client > troll).

12. Brand-deal email watcher — if an email contains words like "sponsorship," "collab," "partnership," it gets a different priority bucket in the morning briefing (separate from regular OPPORTUNITY).

13. Hashtag rotation suggester — monthly, propose 5 new hashtags based on what's trending in the trades content space.

14. 'What worked last month' — first of each month, full breakdown of your top 3 posts and what they had in common.

C. Career & business

15. Lead followup queue — you forward Alfred a lead email, he reminds you after 3 days if you haven't responded. Reminds again at 7 days. Drops it at 14.

16. Job-site arrival check-in — first time each day you arrive at a known address, Alfred logs the start time. (Requires phone integration — more involved.)

17. Tool inventory check — night before a job, Alfred texts "tomorrow you're at [address] for [job type] — don't forget [tool list]." Requires a one-time setup of tool-lists-by-job-type.

18. Union meeting reminders — if your local 638/local 1 calendar is on Google Calendar, Alfred already reminds you. If not, you can hard-code dates.

19. Continuing-ed deadline tracker — NYC licenses, OSHA-30 expirations, etc. Alfred warns 60, 30, and 7 days before expiration.

20. Side-hustle income tracker — tag PayPal incoming as union vs. side-hustle. Monthly breakdown with what's landing where.

D. Learning & growth

21. Daily one-thing — every morning, a single 60-second concept Alfred wants you to learn. Could be HVAC physics, marketing, finance, NYC history — whatever you tell him to focus on.

***RECIPE:** “Add a daily 7:30 AM ‘learn one thing’ text. Rotate between: marketing for creators, personal finance basics, advanced HVAC theory, and one trade fact about NYC.”*

22. Book/video weekly pick — Sunday evening, one carefully chosen book or YouTube video tied to your current focus area.

23. Skill-practice streak — if you’re practicing video editing or sales calls, Alfred tracks whether you did your daily reps.

24. Vocab/term-of-the-day — one new piece of jargon (could be HVAC, could be content-marketing) per day, used in a sentence.

E. Health, home, vehicle

25. Hydration reminders — NYC summer heat. Every 2 hours on days over 85°F.

26. Doctor/dentist auto-prep — 24h before any medical appt, Alfred texts what to bring (insurance card, list of meds, etc.).

27. Truck maintenance log — every 5000 miles or 90 days, ping you to schedule an oil change.

28. HVAC service for your own place — yes, the irony — spring/fall maintenance reminders for your own AC and heating.

29. Step-count nudge — if your day is calendar-light, Alfred suggests a walk or gym block.

F. Personal & family

30. Birthday tracker — one week before family/friend birthdays, Alfred texts a reminder + suggests a gift idea or just “make the call.”

31. ‘Call your mom’ — weekly nudge to keep up with people who matter.

32. Weekend planning — Friday at noon, Alfred texts “what’s the plan for Saturday / Sunday?” — a forcing function to actually plan instead of drifting.

33. Date-night reminder — monthly, prompt to plan something with whoever you’re seeing.

G. davedouglasjr.com — because the site is built and waiting

34. Hosting confirmation tracker — Alfred watches for emails from Network Solutions about the hosting purchase. Notifies you the moment confirmation arrives so you can upload.

35. Uptime monitor — once live, Alfred pings the site every hour. If it goes down, you get a text.

36. Domain renewal warning — 60 days before davedouglasjr.com expires, multiple reminders.

H. Quality of life

37. Weather brief — add NYC weather to the morning briefing (requires adding a free weather API).

38. MTA delay alerts — if your usual subway line has alerts, hear about them before you leave.

39. 'What did I commit to this week?' — Sunday recap of everything you agreed to in emails. Gut-check whether you can deliver.

40. Voice-note inbox — you record a voice memo, email it to Alfred, he transcribes and adds it to a running notes file you can review weekly.

DAVE'S RULE

Don't try to enable all 40. Pick 2-3 that matter THIS month. Alfred's value compounds when you actually use what he sends — not when he buzzes your phone constantly. Add slowly.

06

How to ask Claude to add new features

Claude (this assistant, or your terminal Claude Code) is what built Alfred. He's also what UPGRADES Alfred. The way to get the most out of him is to talk to him like a smart colleague who knows the project.

The recipe — four parts

Good asks have four parts. Skip any and you'll get extra back-and-forth.

1. WHAT	What should Alfred do? Be concrete. "Text me" is good. "Make my life easier" is not.
2. WHEN	What's the trigger? A time? An event? A condition? "Every weekday at noon" / "when an email contains the word 'invoice'".
3. WHERE FROM	What data does Alfred need? Email? Calendar? Bank? Tell him the source.
4. WHY	Optional but helpful. The goal it serves. Claude makes better decisions when he knows the why.

Three worked examples

Example 1 — Adding the IRS countdown

YOU SAY: "Add to the morning briefing a one-line IRS debt countdown. Format: 'IRS payoff: 92 weeks left, needs \$347/week to hit Feb 1 2027.' The current balance and target date are in my memory. Compute the math each day."

Claude edits the morning-briefing function, adds a helper that computes the math, redeploys. Next 6 AM, you see the new line in the briefing.

Example 2 — Adding the daily content prompt

YOU SAY: *“Build a new Alfred job: every weekday at 7 AM, text me one content idea for @dadailydougie. The idea should fit the day of the week (Mon = motivation, Tue = how-to, Wed = behind-the-scenes, Thu = trade fact, Fri = funny). One sentence. Just the idea, no preamble.”*

Claude creates a new edge function (e.g. content - prompt), schedules a new cron at 11 UTC daily (7 AM EDT), and the next morning you get the prompt.

Example 3 — Adding a watcher for specific words

YOU SAY: *“When an email arrives containing ‘sponsorship,’ ‘collab,’ or ‘partnership,’ send me a separate Telegram message immediately tagged ■ BRAND DEAL with the sender, subject, and a link to open it. Don’t wait for the 30-min email check.”*

Claude adds a webhook on Gmail Push notifications (requires one-time setup), or modifies the 30-min checker to have a fast-path for keyword matches.

What NOT to ask

Some things Alfred can't do (yet) or shouldn't do:

- **Send money or pay bills automatically.** Reading account balances is fine. Moving money requires human approval — by design.
- **Make phone calls or send DMs on your behalf.** He can remind, he can prepare drafts, but he doesn't speak on your behalf.
- **Post to social media autonomously.** Draft, suggest, queue — yes. Hit 'publish' — no, that's you.
- **Make legal/medical/financial decisions.** He summarizes information. You decide.

07

Daily and weekly rhythms with Alfred

Your day with Alfred

6:00 AM	Morning briefing arrives. Read it before your first coffee. Note today's move.
6:30 AM – 5 PM	Email scanner runs every 30 min. You get pinged only on score 8+ emails.
Every 15 min	Calendar scan. You get an alert 1h and 15min before every meeting.
End of day	Nothing scheduled — you're off the clock.

Recommended weekly check-ins

Use Claude (the assistant, not Alfred) for these:

Monday morning — *“check on Alfred — anything broken last week?”*

Claude reviews logs, missed runs, and edge-case errors.

Friday afternoon — *“summarize my week from Alfred's logs — what emails were urgent, what meetings I attended, what content I should have posted but didn't.”*

Last day of month — *“monthly Alfred review — cost, usage, any features I asked about that I never implemented.”*

“Check on Alfred” magic phrase

Just say 'check on Alfred' to me (Desktop Claude) or to your terminal Claude. We share the same memory and project directory — either of us can answer instantly. We'll show you cron status, recent runs, recent errors, and any pending changes.

08

Troubleshooting

“I didn’t get my morning briefing”

Order of things to check:

1. Phone is on, signal is fine. (Sounds dumb. Check it anyway.)
2. Check Telegram for the bot message — if Telegram delivered but SMS didn’t, the issue is T-Mobile / the email gateway. If neither arrived, Alfred himself didn’t run.
3. Ask Claude: “*check the morning-briefing logs for today.*”
4. If logs show an error about Gemini quota, see Cost & limits (section 9).

“I’m getting too many urgent email pings”

Threshold is set at 8/10. Lower the rate by raising it to 9/10.

RECIPE: “*Raise the urgent email threshold from 8 to 9. Redeploy.*”

“I’m not getting enough alerts — I missed an urgent one”

Two options: lower the threshold (8 → 7), or add specific keyword-based fast-path overrides.

RECIPE: “*Lower the urgent email threshold to 7. Also, anything from the IRS, my accountant, or my landlord should ALWAYS ping me regardless of score.*”

“Calendar reminders for events I don’t want reminded about”

Two options. Either delete the event from Google Calendar, or tell Alfred to ignore events matching a pattern.

RECIPE: “*Tell the calendar-reminder function to ignore any event with ‘[birthday]’ or ‘[holiday]’ in the title — those don’t need 15-minute warnings.*”

“Alfred is just down. Logs full of errors.”

Three most common causes:

- 1. Gemini free-tier quota hit (1500 requests/day). You’re probably running way under, but if you have a burst of email activity it could exhaust. Fix: create a new AI Studio project + key.
- 2. Google OAuth refresh token expired. Test-mode tokens last 7 days IF the app is unverified. Fix: re-run `scripts/get-google-tokens.ts`.
- 3. Supabase free tier hit a limit (very unlikely — you’re using < 1% of caps).

Where to look without asking Claude

Function logs	supabase.com/dashboard/project/rwhfueaclqcunnoraaix/functions
Cron run history	Supabase → Database → <code>cron.job_run_details</code>
SMS log	Supabase → Table Editor → <code>sms_log</code>
Email scores	Supabase → Table Editor → <code>processed_emails</code>
Telegram bot status	@BotFather in Telegram → <code>/mybots</code>

09

Cost, limits, maintenance

Current monthly cost: \$0

Supabase	Free tier — you use under 1% of caps. No card required.
Google Gemini	Free tier — 1500 requests/day. Alfred uses ~30-50/day.
Gmail API	Free with any Google account.
T-Mobile email-to-SMS	Free. T-Mobile relays the email as a text to your number.
Telegram Bot API	Free, no limits.
Twilio (legacy, unused)	\$1/month for the toll-free number you bought but Alfred doesn't use anymore. Release it to save the dollar.

Where the limits actually live

Each service has caps. None of them are close to being hit. For reference:

Supabase DB rows	500MB — you're using under 1MB.
Supabase function calls	500K/month — you use ~2K/month.
Gemini RPM	10 requests per minute — Alfred bursts to 5.
Gemini daily	1500 requests — Alfred uses ~30-50.
Gmail API daily	1 billion quota units — you use ~5,000.

Maintenance schedule

Alfred is not a needy bot. Here’s the maintenance:

Weekly	Glance at the morning briefing. Are sections all populated? If something’s blank, ask Claude to look.
Monthly	Ask Claude: “check on Alfred — any errors or missed runs this month?”
Twice a year (DST)	Update the morning-briefing cron from 10 UTC → 11 UTC (Nov 1, 2026) and back (Mar 8, 2026 next year).
Every 6 months	If Google requires it, re-run get-google-tokens.ts to refresh OAuth scopes.
As needed	Add new abilities from Section 5’s menu when you have appetite.

HANDS-OFF MODE

Alfred runs whether you’re working or asleep. The only person who needs to do anything is you, and only when you want him smarter or to do something new. Otherwise: he just runs.

10

Quick reference card

The one-page version. Tear out, fold, keep with the manual or stuck on your wall.

Cron schedules (UTC)

purge-old-emails	0 3 * * * (daily 3 AM UTC, cleanup)
morning-briefing	0 10 * * * (daily 10 UTC = 6 AM EDT)
email-checker	*/30 * * * * (every 30 min)
calendar-reminder	*/15 * * * * (every 15 min)

All your secrets (set in Supabase)

GEMINI_API_KEY	AI brain (Google Gemini 2.5 Flash, free tier)
GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID / SECRET / REFRESH_TOKEN	Gmail + Calendar OAuth (read + send scopes)
FROM_EMAIL	bklyncaviar@gmail.com (sender for SMS gateway)
USER_CELL_GATEWAY	9175182963@tmomail.net (your T-Mobile email gateway)
TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN / CHAT_ID	Telegram parallel channel
TWILIO_* (legacy, unused)	Safe to ignore or remove

Useful Claude prompts — copy and paste

“check on Alfred”

“show me the morning briefing logs for today”

“change the morning briefing time to [X AM ET]”

“add a daily 7 AM job that texts me [one thing]”

“what’s the IRS payoff status today” (works if you implement that ability)

“what features could I add this month — give me 3 ideas tied to my goals”

File locations

Project root	~/Documents/Work/Claude Batcave/dave-assistant/
Function code	supabase/functions/{morning-briefing,email-checker,calendar-reminder}/index.ts
Shared modules	supabase/functions/_shared/
Setup checklist	ALFRED-MANUAL.md
This user guide	ALFRED-USER-GUIDE.pdf
Local secrets	.env.local (gitignored — never share)
Claude memory	~/.claude/projects/-Users-sankore/memory/project_alfred.md

URLs

Supabase project	supabase.com/dashboard/project/rwhfueaclqcunnoraaix
Google Cloud project	console.cloud.google.com (project: alfred)
AI Studio	aistudio.google.com/apikey
Telegram bot mgmt	@BotFather in the Telegram app

Alfred is yours. He works for you, not the other way around. If something he does isn’t serving you, change it. If something he doesn’t do would help you, add it. The whole point is leverage — use it.